

In the past five years, the spate of research focused on machine learning has resulted in a boom in the nature and quality of heterogeneous data sources that are being tapped by providers for their customers. Cheaper compute and widespread storage makes it so much easier to apply bulk data processing techniques, and derive insights from existing and unexplored sources of rich user data including logs and traces of activity whilst using software products. Business decision making and strategy

has been primarily dictated by data and is usually supported by business acumen. But in recent times it has not been uncommon to see data providing conclusions seemingly in contrast with conventional business logic.

One could take the simple example of the baseball movie 'Moneyball', in which the protagonist defies all notions of popular wisdom in looking solely at performance statistics to evaluate player viability, eventually building a winning team of players – a team that would otherwise never have come together. The

Entrepreneurial decisions are made using data and business acumen. Big Data is today a tool that helps to maximise revenue and customer engagement. Open source tools like Hadoop, Apache Spark and Apache Storm are the popular choices when it comes to analysing Big Data. As the volume and variety of data in the world grows by the day, there is great scope for the discovery of trends as well as for innovation in data analysis and storage.

A Bird's Eye View of Big Data for Enterprises



Figure 1: Big Data analytics and processing for the enterprise (Source: SmartDataCollective)